

2025

Arvind Singh dies too, leaving behind most properties to son Lakshyaraj Singh. His sister *Padmaja Kumari Parmar*, backed by another sister Bhargavi Kumari Mewar, file a legal challenge to the will. The Supreme Court transfers the case to the Delhi High Court



2026

Proceedings begin. *Vishvaraj Singh*, son of Mahendra Singh, seeks to be impleaded as a party, carrying on the succession battle like his father

end of his life. He would not have denied them their rights, they say, and that large portions of the estate constitute joint family property under Hindu law, and cannot be unilaterally willed away. Last year, they approached the Bombay High Court to claim a case of intestacy i.e. when someone dies without leaving a valid will.

Lakshyaraj, meanwhile, filed a parallel petition in the Rajasthan High Court (Jodhpur bench) seeking Letters of Administration for the will to be probated. "I am deeply hurt by [my sisters'] allegations," Lakshyaraj Singh told INDIA TODAY. "They met him frequently. During his lifetime, one of them took Rs 3 crore and surrendered their directorship in boards and trusts. Why did they never question him then? One of them was with him at his last meal, when he said he would live for at least four more years. That's why we were shocked at his death a few hours later." He adds he can only give the sisters what he owns and not anything that is under a trust, board or company, or a property whose ownership status is under dispute. Neither sister has shared her version with the media, but their petition claims they were denied access to their father.

Now, the Supreme Court has transferred the case to the Delhi High Court for a decisive verdict. But there is a twist. The sisters are now staking claim under the same HUF law that their uncle, Mahendra Singh, had tried to use to wrest control of the properties. His son and their cousin, Vishvaraj Singh, is a BJP MLA from Nathdwara and a recent entrant in the suit after having moved an application seeking to be impleaded as a party. He is taking up the mantle of his father in contesting Bhagwat Singh's original will from the 1980s and argues that any judicial re-examination of succession within Arvind Singh's line inevitably impacts unresolved claims from the elder branch. Moreover, Arvind Singh's will bequeaths some properties that Mahendra Singh bought in Mumbai before his father cut him from the estate.

THE LEGAL MAZE

The one issue that unites Lakshyaraj and Vishvaraj Singh is this: how can Arvind Singh's daughters demand a right over properties which Lakshyaraj does not own? Legal experts say the sisters' challenge reflects a broader shift in inheritance jurisprudence where courts are increasingly scrutinising wills that exclude daughters, even in families with strong patriarchal traditions. But the court must weigh the pendency and finality of earlier judgments against fresh claims, rooted in medical evidence. Sources close to Mewar royals, meanwhile, see the sisters' case as an effort to force an out-of-court settlement. It is likely Vishvaraj Singh will inform the Delhi High Court about other litigations going on about most properties in question in the sisters' case. The Delhi High Court has yet to rule on his impleadment plea.

The move also revives memories of the dramatic 2024 confrontation when Vishvaraj Singh was initially denied access to City Palace for traditional coronation rituals following his father's death—an episode that spilled onto Udaipur's streets and underscored how legal disputes have begun to reshape royal customs. Lakshyaraj Singh has maintained that he never opposed Vishvaraj's entry for prayers but was opposed to it as

> **"I am deeply hurt by my sisters' allegations that our father was not in the right state to write his will. They met him frequently. During his lifetime, they surrendered their directorship in boards and trusts. Why did they never question him then?"**
>
> **LAKSHYARAJ SINGH**
> *Heir to the Mewar estate*

